Persist Week of October 12, 2026

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at support@functional-bodybuilding.com. We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday, October 26th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
- Thursday, October 29th, 2026
- Friday, October 30th, 2026
- Saturday, October 31st, 2026
- Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday, October 26th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
- Thursday, October 29th, 2026
- Friday, October 30th, 2026
- Saturday, October 31st, 2026
- Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday, October 26th, 2026
- Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
- Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
- Thursday, October 29th, 2026
- Friday, October 30th, 2026
- Saturday, October 31st, 2026

- Sunday, November 1st, 2026
- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday, October 26th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 29th, 2026
  - Friday, October 30th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 31st, 2026
  - Sunday, November 1st, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday, October 26th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 29th, 2026
  - Friday, October 30th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 31st, 2026
  - Sunday, November 1st, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday, October 26th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 29th, 2026
  - Friday, October 30th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 31st, 2026
  - Sunday, November 1st, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday, October 26th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 28th, 2026
  - Thursday, October 29th, 2026
  - Friday, October 30th, 2026
  - Saturday, October 31st, 2026
  - Sunday, November 1st, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday, October 26th, 2026
  - Tuesday, October 27th, 2026
  - Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Thursday, October 29th, 2026
Friday, October 30th, 2026
Saturday, October 31st, 2026
Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hollow Body Rock + Suitcase Calf Raise
The rock only works if your lower back stays glued to the floor. Press your ribs down first, then rock from the shoulders instead of throwing the legs. On the calf raise, hold the weight on the same side as the working leg and pause at the top of every rep.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Zercher Drop Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hollow Body Rock; 30 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
1 1/4 Pushup + Reverse DB Fly
The quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time your chest spends in the hardest position, so even bodyweight will bite. Lower all the way, come up a quarter, drop back down, then press all the way up. The reverse fly then hits the back of the shoulder, which usually gets ignored on a pressing day.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling KB Halo; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Glute Bridge Alternating DB Floor Press
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Bent Over Cable Chest Fly or DB Flat Bench Chest Fly; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. DB Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Pushup; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Bent Over Reverse DB Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

Dumbbell Upright Row + Hammer Curl

Dumbbells let your wrists sit where they want on the upright row, which keeps the shoulder happier than a straight bar. Lead with the elbows and stop when they reach shoulder height. The hammer curl then hits the thicker muscle on the outside of the arm.

Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets

1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
3. KB Ballistic Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):

Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):

DB/KB Gorilla Row

4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Dumbbell Upright Row; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Hammer Curl; 10 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
2. Lumbar Roll to Pike Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
3. Elevated Pigeon; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (30 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bicycle Crunch, Heel Taps and Russian Twist
Three core moves back to back with as little rest as you can stand. Slow beats fast here, especially on the bicycle crunch where the shoulder should reach the opposite knee. If the rest is the hard part, start around a minute and cut it down each round.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Landmine Hack Squat
2 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set 1 - 12 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Warm-Up Set 2 - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 2 - 8-10 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 10
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Effort Note:
There are only two working sets here, so both should finish close to failure. Use the warm-up sets to lock in your foot position and depth, then hold that position as the load climbs.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

1. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
directly into
2. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Alternating Dumbbell Curl
Run the rack means you go to failure, drop to a lighter pair, and go again with almost no rest. Start with a weight you could curl about ten times fresh, because the first set is not meant to be the hard one. Keep your elbows pinned to your sides once the burn sets in.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

3. Half Kneeling Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note:
This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Half Kneeling DB/KB See Saw Press
3 Working Sets; rest 2 min between sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 3 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Alternating Dumbbell Curl

"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 alternating dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hollow Body Rock + Suitcase Calf Raise
The rock only works if your lower back stays glued to the floor. Press your ribs down first, then rock from the shoulders instead of throwing the legs. On the calf raise, hold the weight on the same side as the working leg and pause at the top of every rep.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12-15 min):
Zercher Drop Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 75-90 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets

1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec

2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo

rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):

2-3 sets

1. Hollow Body Rock; 30 sec

rest 30 sec

2. Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo

rest 60 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:

1 1/4 Pushup + Bent Over Reverse DB Fly

The quarter rep at the bottom doubles the time your chest spends in the hardest position, so even bodyweight will bite. Lower all the way, come up a quarter, drop back down, then press all the way up. The reverse fly then hits the back of the shoulder, which usually gets ignored on a pressing day.

Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):

3 Rounds

1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling KB Halo; 6 reps/side
5. Split Stance Dual KB Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
DB/KB Gorilla Row
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Glute Bridge Alternating DB Floor Press; 8 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. DB Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2-3 sets
1. 1 1/4 Pushup; 6-10 reps @20X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Bent Over Reverse DB Fly; 12-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (Optional):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Ankles and Wrists Mobility
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand Wrist Circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bicycle Crunch, Heel Taps and Russian Twist
Three core moves back to back with as little rest as you can stand. Slow beats fast here, especially on the bicycle crunch where the shoulder should reach the opposite knee. If the rest is the hard part, start around a minute and cut it down each round.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2. Single Leg DB Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit DB Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Single Arm DB Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
directly into
2. Alternating Single Arm DB Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Alternating Dumbbell Curl
Run the rack means you go to failure, drop to a lighter pair, and go again with almost no rest. Start with a weight you could curl about ten times fresh, because the first set is not meant to be the hard one. Keep your elbows pinned to your sides once the burn sets in.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
3. Half Kneeling Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note:
This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):

Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Alternating Dumbbell Curl
"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:
For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 alternating dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal: Complete 40 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold

Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Alternating Dumbbell Curl
Run the rack means you go to failure, drop to a lighter pair, and go again with almost no rest. Start with a weight you could curl about ten times fresh, because the first set is not meant to be the hard one. Keep your elbows pinned to your sides once the burn sets in.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side
3. Band Pull Apart; 15-20 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
DB/KB Gorilla Row
4 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X0 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Glute Bridge Alternating DB Floor Press; 8 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. DB Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (8 min):
2 sets
Alternating Dumbbell Curl
"Dumbbell Curl Run the Rack"
rest 90-120 sec between sets
Loading Note:

For this finisher, you will start at a weight that you can perform about 10 alternating dumbbell curls with. Perform a set to failure with that weight. Then decrease the weight and perform another set to failure, decrease weight again, and perform another set to failure. Continue in this order until you have done a total of 5 sets to failure. Once you have completed your 5th set to failure, rest 90-120 sec and then repeat one more time.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Banded Lat Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists Mobility
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand Wrist Circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Hollow Body Rock + Suitcase Calf Raise

The rock only works if your lower back stays glued to the floor. Press your ribs down first, then rock from the shoulders instead of throwing the legs. On the calf raise, hold the weight on the same side as the working leg and pause at the top of every rep.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
3. KB Overhead Carry; 20m/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (15 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. DB Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets
1. Hollow Body Rock; 30 sec
rest 30 sec
2. Hand Support Suitcase Single Leg Calf Raise; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1 warmup set. Aim for each set to be close to form failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5-10 reps/side

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Bicycle Crunch, Heel Taps and Russian Twist

Three core moves back to back with as little rest as you can stand. Slow beats fast here, especially on the bicycle crunch where the shoulder should reach the opposite knee. If the rest is the hard part, start around a minute and cut it down each round.
Short on time? Remove Finisher

B) Warmup (10 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
3. Half Kneeling KB Windmill; 5 reps/side
4. Lateral Banded Walk; 10m/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note:
This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:

The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge; 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (10 min):
2-3 sets; rest as needed
30-40 Bicycle Crunch (15-20/side)
20-30 Heel Taps (10-15/side)
20-30 Russian Twist (10-15/side)
Effort Note:
Try to challenge yourself by keeping the rest minimum. If you are unsure start with 30-60 seconds rest between all movements and sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Middle Split; 30 sec
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort

1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The last number in the tempo is a full second standing tall at the top of every rep. That stops you bouncing one rep into the next and makes you reset your brace each time. It sounds small, but by the third set that second is where the set gets hard.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):

3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min EMOM
1st - Bike 30-40 sec @ High Effort
2nd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand (53/35) (Male/Female)
3rd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Switch Lunge
Effort Note:
The 20-30 seconds of rest at each minute will allow you to push the paces a bit higher than 15 minutes of continuous movement, but you will still have to pace appropriately to make it through all 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Wide Grip Bench Press
Your shoulder blades are the base you press from, so pinch them together and down and keep them there for the whole set. If they come loose the bar gets heavy and your shoulders end up taking the load instead of your chest. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so do not empty the tank before you get there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m

3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling Kettlebell Halo; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Bent Over Cable Chest Fly or Dumbbell Flat Bench Chest Fly; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
20-15-10-5-10-15-20
Glute Bridge Dumbbell Floor Press
40-30-20-10-20-30-40
Ring Plank or Tall Plank Seconds
*At the end of each round, complete 30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders
*15 min CAP
Effort Note:
Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Conventional Deadlift
The three second lower is where this lift is won, and it lasts longer than it sounds. Most people rush the way down and lose their back position halfway, so count it out on every rep. Keep the bar dragging close to your legs the whole time and it will feel lighter than it is.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Increasing Effort based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
3. Kettlebell Ballistic Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Increasing Effort (15 min):
3 sets
10 Barbell Bent Over Row
rest 15 sec
20 Russian Twists
rest 15 sec
10 Barbell Sumo Deadlift High Pull
rest 15 sec
Bike 18/15 Calories (Male/Female)
rest 90 sec
Effort Note:
Increasing Bike pace per set. Select a weight for the bent over row that will elicit a hypertrophy stimulus.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
2. Lumbar Roll to Pike Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
3. Elevated Pigeon; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Active Recovery Work (30-40 min):
Goal: Complete 40 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row

2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
Holding the weights at your sides means your midline has to stop you tipping over on every step. Plant the whole front foot before you stand up, rather than falling forward into the next rep. Pick a load you can hold your posture with, because this stops being a leg exercise the moment you start leaning.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice

2. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway) directly into
2. Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway) *rest 90 sec and back to 1*.

Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
4-6 sets
Box Jump Over; 10 reps
rest 10 sec
Bike 18 sec @ 97% effort
rest walk 1:30-2:00
Effort Note:
The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. The set range is meant to be adapted based on your physiology. If you are more powerful you will likely perform fewer sets (because the intensity of each set is higher). If you are more endurant, you may need more sets to achieve the desired stimulus (because the intensity of each set is lower).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Behind the Neck Press
Sitting takes your legs out of the lift, so whatever goes up here is pure shoulder strength. Pull the bar down under control instead of letting it drop, because behind the neck is the one place a fast lower puts you in a bad spot. If the position feels tight today, take the option in the safety note and stop at ninety degrees.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
3. Half Kneeling Kettlebell Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note:
This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (15 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Row 60 sec
20 Kettlebell Ballistic Row (10/side) (53/35) (Male/Female)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Right (53/35)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Left (53/35)
12 Rower Pike Ups
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The last number in the tempo is a full second standing tall at the top of every rep. That stops you bouncing one rep into the next and makes you reset your brace each time. It sounds small, but by the third set that second is where the set gets hard.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min EMOM

1st - Bike 30-40 sec @ High Effort
2nd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand (53/35) (Male/Female)
3rd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Switch Lunge
Effort Note: The 20-30 seconds of rest at each minute will allow you to push the paces a bit higher than 15 minutes of continuous movement, but you will still have to pace appropriately to make it through all 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Wide Grip Bench Press
Your shoulder blades are the base you press from, so pinch them together and down and keep them there for the whole set. If they come loose the bar gets heavy and your shoulders end up taking the load instead of your chest. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so do not empty the tank before you get there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling Kettlebell Halo; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Bent Over Cable Chest Fly or Dumbbell Flat Bench Chest Fly; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
20-15-10-5-10-15-20
Glute Bridge Dumbbell Floor Press
40-30-20-10-20-30-40
Ring Plank or Tall Plank Seconds
*At the end of each round, complete 30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders
*15 min CAP
Effort Note: Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists Mobility
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1 min/side

Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand Wrist Circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Conventional Deadlift
The three second lower is where this lift is won, and it lasts longer than it sounds. Most people rush the way down and lose their back position halfway, so count it out on every rep. Keep the bar dragging close to your legs the whole time and it will feel lighter than it is.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
directly into

2. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
4-6 sets
Box Jump Over; 10 reps
rest 10 sec
Bike 18 sec @ 97% effort
rest walk 1:30-2:00
Effort Note: The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. The set range is meant to be adapted based on your physiology. If you are more powerful you will likely perform fewer sets (because the intensity of each set is higher). If you are more endurant, you may need more sets to achieve the desired stimulus (because the intensity of each set is lower).

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Behind the Neck Press
Sitting takes your legs out of the lift, so whatever goes up here is pure shoulder strength. Pull the bar down under control instead of letting it drop, because behind the neck is the one place a fast lower puts you in a bad spot. If the position feels tight today, take the option in the safety note and stop at ninety degrees.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

3. Half Kneeling Kettlebell Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note: This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note: The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (15 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Row 60 sec
20 Kettlebell Ballistic Row (10/side) (53/35) (Male/Female)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Right (53/35)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Left (53/35)
12 Rower Pike Ups
Effort Note: Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal: Complete 40 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):

Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat

The last number in the tempo is a full second standing tall at the top of every rep. That stops you bouncing one rep into the next and makes you reset your brace each time. It sounds small, but by the third set that second is where the set gets hard.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Glute Bridge Alternating Dumbbell Floor Press; 8 reps/side @21X0 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Dumbbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Row 60 sec
20 Kettlebell Ballistic Row (10/side) (53/35) (Male/Female)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Right (53/35)
6 Single Arm Kettlebell Push Press Left (53/35)
12 Rower Pike Ups
Effort Note: Perform a sustainable pace with a consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Banded Lat Stretch; 30 sec

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min)):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists Mobility
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand Wrist Circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Wide Grip Bench Press
Your shoulder blades are the base you press from, so pinch them together and down and keep them there for the whole set. If they come loose the bar gets heavy and your shoulders end up taking the load instead of your chest. The last set is max reps at your first working weight, so do not empty the tank before you get there.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Increasing Effort based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds

1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling Kettlebell Halo; 6 reps/side
5. Split Stance Dual Kettlebell Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Wide Grip Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note: The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

E) Increasing Effort (15 min):
3 sets
10 Barbell Bent Over Row
rest 15 sec
20 Russian Twists
rest 15 sec
10 Barbell Sumo Deadlift High Pull
rest 15 sec
Bike 18/15 Calories (Male/Female)
rest 90 sec

Effort Note: Increasing Bike pace per set. Select a weight for the bent over row that will elicit a hypertrophy stimulus.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5-10 reps/side

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Conventional Deadlift
The three second lower is where this lift is won, and it lasts longer than it sounds. Most people rush the way down and lose their back position halfway, so count it out on every rep. Keep the bar dragging close to your legs the whole time and it will feel lighter than it is.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
3. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Seated Behind the Neck Press; 8 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note: Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min EMOM
1st - Bike 30-40 sec @ High Effort
2nd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand (53/35) (Male/Female)
3rd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Switch Lunge
Effort Note: The 20-30 seconds of rest at each minute will allow you to push the paces a bit higher than 15 minutes of continuous movement, but you will still have to pace appropriately to make it through all 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Middle Split; 30 sec
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Extension
Passive Hang x 1 min
Seated Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1-2 min
Banded Shoulder Extension x 10 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold

Behind the Back Shoulder Stretch x 1 min/side
PVC Active + Passive Shoulder Extension x 5-10 reps

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Perform

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Squat
The even weeks run the same back squat on a different tempo. At 20X1 you lower for two seconds, come straight out of the bottom with no pause, and stand tall for one, which lets you handle more weight and more reps than the paused weeks. Reps step down inside the session from nine to seven to five as the load climbs each set. Reps drop from Week 2 on this version, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):

2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
Every 2:00-3:00 x 5 sets
1 Hang Clean + 1 Low Hang Clean
rest until next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 9 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust; 10-12 reps @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Raise; 6-10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min EMOM
1st - Bike 30-40 sec @ High Effort
2nd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand (53/35) (Male/Female)
3rd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Shuttle Run (10m)
Effort Note:
The 20-30 seconds of rest at each minute will allow you to push the paces a bit higher than 15 minutes of continuous movement, but you will still have to pace appropriately to make it through all 15 minutes.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Wide Grip Bench Press
The wide grip bench press alternates with the close grip across this cycle. Taking the hands wider shortens the distance the bar travels and puts more of the work on the chest and front delts instead of the triceps. Keep the shoulder blades pinched down and back so the shoulders stay in a safe position at the wider grip. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up. Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling Kettlebell Halo; 6 reps/side

C) Gymnastics HOT START (12 min):
4 sets
2 min TIMER:
Row 12/10 Cal (Male/Female)
AMRAP Bar Muscle Up in Remaining Time

1 min rest between sets

Loading Note:

If you need to regress the muscle up, perform the following:

AMRAP Burpee Pullup

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):

Wide Grip Bench Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2 min

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8

Working Set 3 - 6 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.

RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets

1. Bent Over Cable Chest Fly or Dumbbell Flat Bench Chest Fly; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 30 sec

2. Dumbbell Skullcrushers; 12 reps @30X0 Tempo

rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):

For Time

20-15-10-5-10-15-20

Glute Bridge Dumbbell Floor Press

40-30-20-10-20-30-40

Ring Plank or Tall Plank Seconds

*At the end of each round, complete 30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders

*15 min CAP

Effort Note:

Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

G) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets

1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side

3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Conventional Deadlift
The conventional deadlift alternates with the Romanian across this cycle. Pulling from the floor brings the quads and the whole back into it and lets you handle far more weight than the Romanian version. Keep the bar against the legs and drive the hips and shoulders up together so the bar never drifts forward. Reps step down inside the session from seven to five to three, and drop from Week 2, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Banded Goodmorning; 10-15 reps
3. Kettlebell Ballistic Row; 10 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15-18 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
1 Hang Power Snatch + 1 Low Hang Power Snatch + 1 Power Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Sets 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Conventional Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 5 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 3 reps @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

F) Power Conditioning (13 min):
Every 2:30 x 5 sets
8 Devils Press
8 Box Jump Overs
20 sec Row SPRINT
rest until the start of the next 2:30
Effort Note:
*Use the following guide in order to approach each set with escalating effort on the Row.
Set 1 - Moderate Effort - RPE 7-8
Set 2 - Hard Effort - RPE 8-9
Sets 3-5 - Maximal Effort - RPE 9-10

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Childs Pose Reach Through; 30 sec/side
2. Lumbar Roll to Pike Stretch; 5 reps with 5 sec stretch
3. Elevated Pigeon; 30-60 sec/side

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist PERFORM

A) Active Recovery Work (30-40 min):
Goal: Complete 40 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (12 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold

Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
The suitcase short step walking lunge alternates with the rear foot elevated split squat across this cycle. Taking a shorter step keeps the load on the quad of the front leg rather than sharing it with the glute, and walking adds a grip and core demand the split squat does not have. Keep the torso tall and use straps if grip fails before the legs do. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Barbell Cycling based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Kettlebell and Plyometric HOT START (9 min):
Every 60 sec x 9 min
Minute 1) 4 Right Arm Kettlebell Clean + 4 Right Arm Kettlebell Thruster
Minute 2) 4 Left Arm Kettlebell Clean + 4 Left Arm Kettlebell Thruster
Minute 3) 5 Continuous Vertical Jump

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Suitcase Short Step Walking Lunge
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 8 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 reps/side @20X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets

1. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
directly into
2. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Barbell Cycling (12 min):
3 sets @ High Effort
Row 15/12 Calories (Male/Female)
Power Snatch x 6 (95/65)
Burpee Over Bar x 6
rest 2 min between sets
Effort Note:
With each set increase your speed on the Row and attempt to cycle the barbell with greater efficiency and/or speed.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Seated Behind the Neck Press
The seated behind the neck press alternates with the Z press across this cycle. Pressing from behind the head keeps the bar directly over the shoulders through the whole path, which builds strength in the exact position an overhead squat or a snatch asks for. This one asks a lot of shoulder flexibility, so take the option in the safety note and stop at ninety degrees at the elbow if the range is not there. Reps drop from Week 2 on this variation, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
3. Half Kneeling Kettlebell Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Upper HOT START (10 min):
4 Rounds - Increasing your row pace on each round
4 Supinated Strict Pullup
8 Yoga Pushups
15/12 Calories Row (Male/Female)
Intention Note:
Start easy and gradually build up speed and intensity.

D) Strength Intensity 1 (15 min):
Seated Behind the Neck Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 7 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Safety Note:
This exercise demands flexibility in the shoulders. If you have limited mobility, lower until the elbow is at 90 degrees and then press back up. You may use a wider grip than your normal strict press.

E) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Functional Pump Conditioning (12-15 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Row 60 sec

20 Kettlebell Ballistic Row (10/side) (53/35) (Male/Female)
6 Kettlebell Push Press Right (53/35)
6 Kettlebell Push Press Left (53/35)
12 Rower Pike Ups
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM

This week is about something I see happen all the time. Restarting instead of continuing.

You keep restarting instead of continuing. And I get it, it's tempting. Missing a week feels like you broke something, and starting fresh feels cleaner than picking up in the middle.

But your body doesn't reset the way your brain does. The fitness you built doesn't disappear after a week off. The habits you developed are still there. When you treat every interruption like a reason to start over, you spend a lot of time at the beginning and not much time making real progress.

Pick it back up where you left off. Even if it's messy. Even if you have to scale back a little at first. Continuity, even imperfect continuity, will always beat restarting.

Warmly,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday, October 26th, 2026

Week 4 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Dual Dumbbell Front Squat
The front squat alternates with the cyclist squat across this cycle. Holding both dumbbells at your shoulders forces your upper back and midsection to keep you upright, so the position usually fails before your legs do. At 20X1 you lower for two seconds, come straight out of the bottom with no pause, and stand tall for one. Reps climb on this version as the block goes on rather than dropping, so expect more work at a weight you can hold cleanly.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Aerobic Lower Body based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
3 Sets
1. Banded Reverse Nordics; 6-8 reps
2. Ring Assisted Cossack Squat; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Dual Dumbbell Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Single Leg Hip Thrust; 10 reps/side @21X1 Tempo
rest 60 sec
2. Bent Knee Copenhagen Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Aerobic Lower Body (15 min):
15 min EMOM
1st - 30-40 sec Shuttle Run @ High Effort
2nd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Goblet Tall Kneel to Stand (53/35) (Male/Female)
3rd - 30-40 sec AMRAP Switch Lunge
Effort Note:
The 20-30 seconds of rest at each minute will allow you to push the paces a bit higher than 15 minutes of continuous movement, but you will still have to pace appropriately to make it through all 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Foot Elevated Hip Flexion Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Butterfly Stretch; 60 sec
3. Shinbox Switch; 5 reps/side

Tuesday, October 27th, 2026

Week 4 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Dual Dumbbell Arnold Press
The Arnold press starts with your palms facing you and rotates them out as you press, which takes your shoulder through more range than a straight press. Rotate on the way up rather than turning at the top, or the twist does nothing. It alternates with the seated alternating press across the cycle, and this version lets you handle more total weight because both arms work together. Reps climb from Week 2 rather than dropping.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Press Core Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Quadruped Crawl; 10m
3. Reverse Quadruped Crawl; 10m
4. Tall Kneeling Kettlebell Halo; 6 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (15 min):
Dual Dumbbell Arnold Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 min
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Max Unbroken reps @20X1 Tempo - RPE 10 - Set 1 weight.
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Dumbbell Flat Bench Chest Fly; 8 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 30 sec
2. Narrow Grip Tricep Pushup; 10-15 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Press Core Conditioning (15 min):
For Time
20-15-10-5-10-15-20
Glute Bridge Dumbbell Floor Press
40-30-20-10-20-30-40
Ring Plank or Tall Plank Seconds
*At the end of each round, complete 30 Double Unders or 50 Single Unders
*15 min CAP
Effort Note:
Perform this at a consistent pace. Select a weight that you could perform for 15 reps @RPE 8-9.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Single Arm Pec Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Pretzel Stretch; 30 sec/side
3. PVC Prayer Stretch; 30-60 sec

Wednesday, October 28th, 2026

Week 4 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (30 min):
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Ankles and Wrists Mobility
Ankle Circles x 5 reps/direction
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1 min/side
Heel Sit x 1 min
Toe Sit x 1 min
Hand to Hand Wrist Circles x 30 sec
Wrist Extension Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Flexion Stretch x 1 min
Wrist Isometrics x 3-5 reps with 5 sec hold
Quadruped Wrist Circles x 5-10 reps/direction

Thursday, October 29th, 2026

Week 4 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Single Leg Hand Support Dumbbell RDL
The single leg version alternates with the two leg RDL across this cycle. Your hand on a bench or wall is there for balance only, so keep your weight in the working leg and resist the urge to push through it. Let the back leg travel straight behind you and keep your hips square, because the top hip will want to open as you fatigue. Reps drop from Week 2, so the weight goes up.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Anaerobic Power Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
1. 90 sec Cardio of Choice
2. Single Leg Dumbbell Glute Bridge; 10 reps/side
3. Deficit Dumbbell Sumo Deadlift; 10 reps

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Single Leg Hand Support Dumbbell RDL
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 min
Warm-Up Set - 8 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 7 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 5 reps/side @30X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets
1. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Kickstand Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
directly into
2. Alternating Single Arm Dumbbell Rack Cossack Squat; 10 reps (5/side, switch the rack arm at halfway)
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Anaerobic Power Conditioning (15 min):
5 sets
10 Box Jump Over
10 Dual Dumbbell Power Clean
15 Squat Jumps
rest walk 90 sec
Effort Note:
The goal is maximal output, do NOT pace. All 5 sets should be at the same maximal effort, so take the full rest walk between them.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Dynamic Adductor Stretch; 30 sec/side
2. Half Kneeling Weight Shift; 30 sec/side
3. Middle Split; 30 sec

Friday, October 30th, 2026

Week 4 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Pronated Strict Pullup
The clock matters more than the load here, and every set starts whether you are ready or not. Reps come down as you go so each set stays clean, which is the whole point of this format. Pick assistance that lets you finish the last set looking like the first, not one that has you scraping through.
Short on time? Remove Strength Balance or Functional Pump Conditioning based on your goals.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice

3 Sets
1. 15 sec Cardio Sprint
2. Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps
3. Half Kneeling Kettlebell Windmill; 5 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (8 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup
Every 75 sec x 6 sets
Set 1: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 2: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 3: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 8
Set 4: 5 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 5: 3 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
Set 6: 2 reps @21X0 Tempo - RPE 9
RPE = Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure.
Loading Note:
The format will remain the same for all even weeks, aim to decrease assistance/increase weight or improve quality throughout this training block.

D) Strength Balance (10 min):
3 sets
1. Inchworm Pushup; 6-8 reps
rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Front Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0 Tempo
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Perform 1-2 warmup sets to determine starting weight. Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Functional Pump Conditioning (12 min):
12 min AMRAP @ sustainable effort
Run 60 sec
20 Dumbbell Gorilla Row (10/side)
6 Single Arm Dumbbell Push Press Right
6 Single Arm Dumbbell Push Press Left
12 Pike Leg Lift Over (6/side)
Effort Note:
Perform a sustainable pace with consistent or very gradual increase in heart rate or breathing for all 12 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1. Banded Lat Stretch; 30-60 sec/side
2. Active Scratch Test; 5 reps/side
3. Wall Reverse Shoulder Circles; 10 reps/side

Saturday, October 31st, 2026

Week 4 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work (40 min):
Goal: Complete 40 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Leg Hip Thrust Isometric/leg
2nd) 20 sec Side Plank/side
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort
EMOM x 6 min
1st) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Plank/arm
2nd) 20 sec Single Arm Ring Row Hold/arm
Run/Bike/Row
2:00 @65% effort
1:30 @70% effort
1:00 @75% effort
1:30 @70% effort
2:00 @65% effort

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION (10 min):
Shoulder Flexion
Passive Hang x 1 min
Sidelying Thoracic Rotation x 5-10 reps/side with 5 sec hold
PVC Lat Stretch x 1-2 min
Prone Shoulder Flexion x 5 reps with 3 sec hold
Banded Lat Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Banded Shoulder Flexion x 10 reps
Prone Shoulder Swimmer x 5 reps

Sunday, November 1st, 2026

Week 4 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST

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Warmly,
Marcus